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Small Enterprise Development
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TREP is now enhanced

SEDFA
SMALL ENTERPRISE DEVELOPMENT AND FINANCE AGENCY

TOWNSHIP & Rural Entrepreneurship Programme

Fund Brochure



What Is TREP?

The Township and Rural Entrepreneurship Programme (TREP) is a DSBD programme implemented through its agency, SEDFA, to support township and rural enterprises with affordable finance, blended finance options and business development support to help MSMEs grow sustainably.

What's New in TREP?

- Funding of up to R3 million per business.
- The programme offers tiered fixed-rate debt pricing, set at 5% fixed for loan amounts up to R1 million and 8% fixed on facilities exceeding R1 million up to the R3 million ceiling.
- Repayment terms of up to 60 months.
- Moratorium of up to 6 months on capital and interest, based on your cashflow.
- Blended finance: 60% loan and a grant of up to 40%, determined by SEDFA's Grant Scorecard.
- Open to all sectors — including digital, green economy, creative and tourism.
- Business development and post-investment support.

Am I Eligible?

- Registered with CIPC (including co-operatives and sole proprietors)
- 100% South African-owned
- Operating in a township or rural area
- Registered with SARS
- Valid business bank account
- At least one owner actively involved in running the business

Who Should Apply?

- Township-based MSMEs and co-operatives
- Rural-based MSMEs and co-operatives
- Growing and scaling enterprises

How to Apply

Step 1: Check eligibility

Step 2: Prepare your documents: CIPC documents, SARS, proof of address and six months' bank statements

Step 3: Apply online at www.sedfa.org.za — select TREP. SEDFA offices, municipal LED offices and Business Regulation Officers can help you apply

Step 4: Assessment and approval by SEDFA

Step 5: Contracting, disbursement and support begins

Priority is given to businesses owned by women, youth and persons with disabilities.

Additional Benefits

- A competitive 5% fixed rate on facilities up to R1 million (8% above R1 million), for predictable repayments.
- Up to 6 months before repayments begin, giving your business time to grow.
- A blended loan-and-grant model designed to make finance more accessible.
- Spread repayments over up to 60 months for greater financial flexibility.
- Mentorship, site visits and market-access support after funding.

Please Note

- The grant portion is up to 40% and is determined by SEDFA's Grant Scorecard. A stronger business case, inclusion profile and job creation earn a larger grant.
- All applicants must be willing to complete SEDFA's Business Development Services programme (3–6 months).
- Funds may be paid directly to suppliers or service providers rather than to the applicant.
- Not eligible: persons under debt review or insolvency, businesses under business rescue or liquidation, labour broking, and entities on DFI delinquency registers.

